Cornell University

Fall 2024

Announcing Structural Democracy Fellowship

The Data and Democracy Lab (also known as MGGG), based at the Brooks School of Public Policy at Cornell University, will award 5-10 fellowships in its 2025 cohort of Structural Democracy Fellows. Each fellow will be awarded $20,000-$80,000 for the 2025 calendar year. This is the first of a planned three years of Structural Democracy Fellowships, totaling an expected $300,000 per year. The goal of these fellowships is to build and strengthen a research community in Structural Democracy, which is meant to include a range of practically applicable areas in the study of systems of election.

Topics include (computational) social choice, mechanism design, computational redistricting, statistical models of elections, data visualization for elections, behavioral psychology of ranking and voting, dynamics of turnout and engagement, and the design of law and policy around voting.

Expectations for Structural Democracy Fellows.

- Conduct research as described in your proposal.
- Regularly attend one-hour weekly zoom seminar – Topics in Structural Democracy. (Time to be chosen by poll.)
- Speak in seminar at least once in 2025, and propose other speakers for seminar.
- Submit article for *Designing Democracy*, a special issue of the Harvard Data Science Review, for submission deadline of July 31, 2025 or December 31, 2025.
- Review 2-4 articles for that special issue.

Application Materials.

- A research proposal of approximately 2 pages briefly summarizing past work in structural democracy and outlining future plans. Indicate which terms are covered by this proposal: Spring 2025 (Feb/Mar/Apr/May), Summer 2025 (June/July/Aug), Fall 2025 (Sept/Oct/Nov/Dec).
- CV with publication list.
- Budget request in the range listed above. Should include narrative budget justification as well as table or bulleted list of associated expenses.

Examples of reasonable expenses include: sabbatical replacement salary, course buyout at your university rate, student researcher hourly pay, semester salary for graduate students or postdocs, funding towards small summer program, summer salary within your university guidelines, materials, travel support. Grants must be paid through a college or university, but non-academic applicants are welcome to seek university sponsorship to house the funding.

To apply, please send application materials in PDF format to Cally Crane (cc2899@cornell.edu) with the subject line "Structural Democracy Fellowship Application," by Monday, December 30, 2024. Earlier applications are appreciated. Notifications about grant awards will be made by January 15, 2025. For more information, please contact PI Moon Duchin (mduchin@cornell.edu).